

KF Introduction to NHG

Chapter 5: *Self-Hate and Self-Contempt*¹

We are now half-way through our study together, and I hope that you will give yourself the option to join Karis Fellowships by finishing the book study. Karis Fellowships is a support and training program for those who are beginning to understand the problem of neurosis and are willing to make the effort to extricate themselves from the pride system of the idealized self. In the last lesson, we were reminded that God resists the proud but gives grace to the humble. God's grace is a gift that invites human creatures into an ever-enriching relationship with their Creator. These creatures of grace are called Christians. They are learning to give up their pride system and disengage from the imagined identity of their idealized self.

We want God's support, but because our pride is set on fulfilling our search for personal glory, we want that support on our own terms. When God and life do not agree with our terms, we feel deeply upset, and we severely judge and blame ourselves for not being wonderful enough to achieve our illusions of glory. Dr. Horney calls this reaction *self-hate*. Avoiding the terrors and pain of self-hate then becomes the primary motivation for everything we do.

When you read about the characters in the Old Testament, look at how they experience and express self-hate. They attack others or invite attack; they do nothing about their problems or over-react to them; they make outrageous mistakes. They believe that everyone is against them, including God, or they arrogantly assume that they are lucky enough to risk disaster, which inevitably invites disaster. They resist change, align themselves with destructive people and lifestyles, turn to idols, become sexually compulsive, hurt their children, and even kill themselves. Isn't it startling how the Bible records the details of their self-hate? Why do humans hate themselves? They hate themselves because they have not and cannot live up to their own self-imposed standards.

With this understanding of self-hate, Nancy would like to offer her paraphrase of Romans 7:19-24. In this passage, the Apostle Paul describes his inner battle with self-hate:

"For I do not create the good that I want, but I end up achieving what I do not want, something disgusting and harmful. ²⁰If I myself am creating what I do not want, then it is not I who am laboring to this end, but it is this failure and guilt living in me. ²¹I then reveal this law: when I desire to create good, evil is right there with me. ²²I can explain it this way—I am happy with God's law within my real person, ²³but I see a second law in my bodily frame battling the law of my mind, and in that law of failure and guilt I am imprisoned within that frame. ²⁴Oh, I am such a miserable person! Who will rescue me from this body of death?"

Let's take a deep breath.

Paul has very high ideals for himself but finds them impossible to achieve. In chapter 8, however, we learn that he has finally resolved his dilemma. He doesn't find the solution in working harder at being or doing what he thinks he *should* be or do, nor in heaping more claims and shoulds upon himself and others. So, what is Paul's solution to his dilemma, and to the dilemma of every human being who seeks a relationship

¹ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

with God? The solution is found in the person of Jesus Christ through whom each of us is invited to have a karis, not a legal, relationship with God. As Paul joyfully declares in the next chapter, “So then, there is now no condemnation (legal or otherwise!) for those who are in Christ Jesus.” To put it another way, when we are in karis relationship with God through Jesus, we discover that there is no occasion or basis for self-hate. As His people, we are free to make mistakes, train, learn, develop, and remodel our lives without fear of punishment or condemnation. Like healthy children, we are free to grow.

KF Facilitator Guide

Chapter 5: *Self-Hate and Self-Contempt*¹

0:00 Weekly/0:00 Weekend Intensive (WI)

Lead Facilitator starts the recording by pressing *9.

“Welcome everyone to chapter 5 of *Neurosis and Human Growth*. We will begin our study by reading Nancy’s introduction to the chapter.”

Support Facilitator reads the Introduction.

Lead Facilitator: “Thank you. Let’s go to Presenting. When you give us your name and location, you might also share something that you did recently that was fun or playful. I will begin.”

“My name is _____. I am calling from _____. Something fun I did recently was _____.”

- Facilitators open the [NHG Spreadsheet](#) to record attendance and homework completion.
- Each facilitator makes a list of the names of students as they present.
- Lead facilitator prepares group divisions while students present.
- Lead facilitator assigns groups and says, “To leave the main group, press *3 and then, when prompted, enter your group number. To return to the main group, press *3*.”
- Each facilitator asks, “Is there anyone who has not filled out their reading guide?”
- Each facilitator assigns the first 10 questions to two students, 5 questions each. Continue to answer the questions in sets of 10, assigning 5 questions per student in rotation.

Question 11, 12, 16, 24, 26, 31, 33, and 35 are open to the whole group, and there are no correct answers.

0:10/0:05 WI

1. When we shift our center of gravity to the idealized self, what does the glorified self become? (110.2)
The glorified self becomes not only a phantom to be pursued, but also a measuring rod with which to measure our actual being.

2. When the human being which we actually are interferes with our flight to glory, what are we bound to do? (110.2)

We are bound to hate ourselves.

Our actual being (how we act, think, feel, and express ourselves in the present moment) is an embarrassment and keeps interfering with our flight to glory.

We can even be proud of the fact that we hate ourselves because we don’t measure up to our high standards.

3. The drive to become a splendid being is doomed to failure, but what at best may neurotics be able to do? (111.2)

They may at best be able to eliminate from awareness some disturbing discrepancies between their actual self and their idealized self.

We will ignore our limitations of energy, time, power, or endurance, whether physical or emotional. We think that we should be a well-oiled machine.

We might rewrite our history to match our idealized illusions about ourselves.

4. Who are the two persons involved in the neurotic's conflict? (111.3)

- A. **The unique, ideal person**
- B. **The omnipresent stranger—the actual self**

The actual self is always disturbing, embarrassing, and interfering with our efforts.

- The neurotic might have a growing feeling of being a fraud or a freak, someone who is abnormal.
- A woman regularly dreamed that a strange dark-haired woman was always with her. This stranger never spoke, neither could the woman ever see her face. Her actual self was that stranger.
- Nightmares often indicate that the consciousness of the actual self is trying to emerge.

5. What is the essential characteristic of every neurotic? (112.2)

Neurotics are at war with themselves.

If we continue to make choices that support our pride, God is also at war with us, and we might believe that life is just a series of conflicts and battles. There is a real fight, however. We train hard to fight easy against the many forces that oppose the development of our real self. In KF we call this real fight the "good fight". When we start fighting for the real self, God can fight for us. He becomes our ally in the battle.

6. What happens when the pride system starts to totter and a person becomes closer to the real self? (112.3)

The opposing forces line up. Self-hate becomes increasingly directed against the emerging constructive forces of the real self.

This opposition creates even more inner conflict for us and can make us believe that things are getting worse. People often quit KF training when they begin to engage with these conflicts. They are unwilling to enter into this uncomfortable stage of transition. Nightmares may start. We might confuse what is real and what is ideal.

One of the most important goals of training with KF is to learn how to manage our self-hate and this inner battle.

7. What is the "central inner conflict"? (113.1)

A conflict between healthy and neurotic, constructive and destructive forces.

As Christians we might think of this as the conflict between grace and law or between the spirit and the flesh.

8. What is the real self, with its capacity for growth, doing in the midst of this inner conflict? (113.1)

The real self is fighting for its life.

We are also fighting for our connection to our Creator and His design.

It is very important to understand that our children need to learn how to fight for their real lives. We can appreciate their efforts, and when we have done the work to learn those skills for ourselves, we can help them learn how to fight for themselves productively.

9. Why do we hate ourselves? (114.2)

We hate ourselves, not because we are worthless, but because we are driven to reach beyond ourselves. Our hatred results from the discrepancy between what we would be and what we are.

The “Sanctification Gap”: Christians are often caught in the illusion of an idealized spirituality, knowing what they should be but being daily confronted with what they actually are.

We think that if we only had enough faith, all things would be possible for us, even our idealized illusions. Faith would then be the magic wand that would recreate us into godlike beings. Our focus is then diverted toward achieving our illusions, and we neglect to develop our real assets and strengths. We don’t even value them because our real assets don’t measure up to our illusions.

It’s quite a challenge to convince Christians that the only mark of real mature spirituality is the ever-growing Fruit of God’s Spirit evidenced in their choices and behavior. To achieve the illusion of spiritual growth, we learn behaviors that we hope will pass as real spirituality, and we are particularly satisfied when others are impressed by those behaviors. One of our goals in KF is to offer members a vision of what real Christian maturity might look like for each member and teach them how they can achieve it for themselves.

10. Before neurotics can set going a constructive move, what must they feel? (115.2)

They must feel some sympathy for the suffering self.

We also must begin to appreciate all of the ways that we inflict suffering on ourselves. In KF we train ourselves to honor the healing process of suffering, and we cooperate with the training opportunity that suffering offers to us.

11. Drawing on Horney’s examples and your own experience, what are the results of self-hate? (116.2)

Open this question to the group. Dr Horney’s examples are in bold.

- **Feeling guilty, inferior, cramped, tormented**
- I cannot take credit for my accomplishments
- I wish that the person I am were non-existent
- Refusing to do my KF work
- Undermining my life with self-sabotage, de-valuing my assets
- Obsessive self-torturing thoughts, a need for revenge, and compulsive self-justification
- Constantly comparing myself to others
- Cramped, restricted, “living in a straight-jacket”
- Allowing others to control me with their expectations
- Car accidents, self-harm, harming others, sexual predation, addictions, rage attacks, guilt and shame
- Fighting and defending illusions that I foster about myself that are not supported by evidence
- Claiming qualities that we don’t actually have in an effort to avoid self-hate

0:25/0:15 WI

12. From your own experience, what sins against your self could be blurred by pride? (116.2)

Open this question to the group.

- Winning or asserting superiority, but at the expense of self-management or important relationships
- Self-sacrifice, which is really fear of investing in ourselves; being always available to help others
- Punishing ourselves, which we think is humility and grief over our failures
- Overburdening, overscheduling, overworking, over-avoiding, over-socializing, over-giving, overspending
- Speeding, breaking rules, last minute timing
- Controlling others, which distracts us from managing ourselves
- Claiming thriftiness when in reality we do not allow ourselves to want anything
- Calling obsessive anxiety a responsible concern for justice
- Claiming that we are generous, unselfish, responsible, loyal, trustworthy, and minding our own business, but our lives actually reflect self-destruction and chaos
- Being a slave to duty so that I can avoid my own work or mission
- Focusing on career, or success, but in reality I am unbalanced and completely unskilled in important areas of life

13. Horney roughly distinguishes between what two forms of externalized self-hate? (116.3)

A. Active—self-hate is directed outward against life, fate, institutions, people

- We throw emotional grenades at others when we sense that our pride system is threatened.
- We attack others whom we imagine are undermining our search for glory.
- Hating other politics, gender, race, sports teams, socio-economic groups, etc.
- Making someone else the enemy, the obstacle, the liability in our own mind.
- Examples of externalized self-hate:
 - A Democrat assumes that any Republican is greedy and dishonest
 - A Republican assumes that any Democrat is leeching and immoral
 - Women are scary
 - Men are bad
 - Any race other than mine is threatening
 - All rich people are selfish
 - All poor people are lazy

B. Passive—hate remains directed against the self but is perceived as coming from the outside

- We have buried landmines in our souls and then invite others to step on them so that we can blame others for our feelings or outcomes.
- We imagine that we are victims of another's choices to avoid taking responsibility for our own lives: "They are making me feel this way."
- Allowing ourselves or others in our care to be abused.
- Creating events that undermine our lives but blaming others or God.
- Believing that others are out to get me or want to harm me; I am the target of evil people. People are dangerous.
- Interpreting another's communication as an attack, an act of hostility, rejection, judgment, abandonment, belittling, or condemnation.
- Personalizing the negative attitudes of another person, group, or institution.
- Unconsciously inviting attack from others and then feeling unjustly treated.

- Aligning oneself with untrustworthy people and then feeling abused by them.
- Allowing others too much freedom of expression and behavior.
- Maintaining poor boundaries.

14. What are the six modes of operation in, or expressions of, self-hate? (117.4)

- A. **Relentless demands on self**
- B. **Merciless self-accusation**
- C. **Self-contempt**
- D. **Self-frustrations**
- E. **Self-tormenting**
- F. **Self-destruction**

15. What seems to be the whole point of self-hate? (118.1)

To destroy the self as painfully as possible.

The very thing that God wants to make glorious is the thing that we are trying to destroy. When we see others making foolish choices or committing the same mistakes, we might feel compassion.

God wants us to work with Him to change this destructive pattern. We might understand Ezekiel 18:31 as a plea to stop acting out of self-hate: "Cast away from you all your transgressions which you have committed and make yourselves a new heart and a new spirit! For why will you die, O house of Israel?"

16. Do you recognize any of these or other shoulds within your own neurotic system? (118.3–120.2)

Open this question to the group.

- Mastery: I should not let anyone shine more than me or get credit for anything.
- Self-effacing: I should be responsible for others; I should be big enough not to mind anything that is done to me.
- Resigned: I should be able to avoid the responsibility for that outcome; I should have no strong feelings.

17. What is the first striking factor of a person on the verge of realization? (121.2-3)

Making insistent frenzied claims for special consideration and feeling abused when those claims are frustrated.

These claims stem from a sudden increase in neurotic needs. When we realize that we cannot fulfill our imperative shoulds, we desperately want the world and others to do it for us.

When we can't recruit others or the world to support us, we become hysterical. Hysteria can appear as withdrawing, attacking, illness or helplessness, anxiety, accidents, foolish choices, intense sense of blame, rage and revenge, or clinging demands.

18. What are two self-deceptive measures that the neurotic takes? (122.4—123.1)

- A. **Lowering the threshold of awareness of ourselves.**

Most people lower their awareness of themselves to avoid their emotional pain. This is why in our KF training we learn to be aware of ourselves. We begin to face the pain that drove us away from self-awareness in the first place and learn new skills to deal with the pain.

- B. **Experiencing oneself only as a reacting being.**

Life is experienced as a sequence of pushes and pulls, all coming from the outside. “Life happens to me.”

Students have shared their examples of living as reacting beings:

- It’s all their fault that I’m not happy
- I feel alive in a crisis because it gives me something to do and feel
- Being crazy busy distracts me from myself and I can let the schedule take responsibility for my choices
- I never think about who I am in the process; I am on autopilot

19. What is another expression of self-hate? (123.5)

Condemnatory self-accusations.

20. What is a more productive response to our neurotic affliction? (125.1)

To be sympathetic with ourselves for our struggles and afflictions, and then examine the problem for what it actually is.

Take the Believe It Path – step out of the emotional tidal wave and look at what is.

0:40/0:25 WI

21. What may seem to be the very image of conscientious scrutiny? (125.3)

Self-accusations that hit less at existing difficulties than at the motivations for doing something.

Searching for motives in order to condemn ourselves instead of recognizing that our lack of training and poor choices account for the outcomes we are experiencing.

Two ways of avoiding the existing difficulties that cause our problems:

- A. We are in a mess. We could take responsibility for having gotten ourselves into the mess, but instead we examine our motives thinking that they are the problem. Examining motives prevents us from learning the direct cause and effect of our choices.
- B. Conscientious scrutiny may be especially attractive to Christians who have high standards for themselves that they can never consistently maintain. We might incessantly go over our mistakes which feels like we are trying to learn or to figure out what is right, but instead we just feel worse. We confess our sins, spend hours in prayerful tears, make new commitments to do better, even fast, or apologize to the world. This all feels humble and justly chastising, but in reality we are just working out self-hate. We can’t understand why we continue to repeat the pattern. We have satisfied our need to do the right thing by acknowledging how things should be but haven’t really addressed the search for glory that is driving our pride system.

We need to have compassion on ourselves. Most of us have never been taught how to change or how to heal. It is excruciating to keep making the same mistakes and yet not know how to stop. In KF, we learn how to heal and be trained.

22. What are the two self-protective measures that ward off severe self-recrimination? (128.1)

- A. **Treating oneself in a gingerly way**—be casual, forget it, make excuses, discount the effects, tell stories that make it seem reasonable, offer light apologies which should make it all right.

- B. **Shifting responsibility to circumstances**—this creates a dilemma because outside factors should not be outside our control; everything that goes wrong reminds us of our disgraceful limitations.

We give away our personal power when we avoid our growth by shifting responsibility to outside circumstances. If we shift responsibility, we never develop the confidence and the power to change ourselves.

Through our own healing process, we learn to appreciate how difficult or impossible it is for others to see their own imperfections. As we get healthier, we become more patient with the process of others and are able to give them a safe place to heal because we no longer depend on them to support our pride and deliver us from self-hate.

23. Self-accusations about actions and attitudes which, viewed objectively, seem harmless, legitimate, or even desirable often concern what? (130.2)

The fight against the emerging real self.

We might accuse ourselves of being gluttons when we are simply enjoying some food. If we have sexual feelings, we accuse ourselves of lust or depravity. We may want to have more resources but then instantly accuse ourselves of greed. If we show mercy to someone or stop judging a situation, we accuse ourselves of getting lazy, soft, or irresponsible.

24. Which of these or other examples of self-accusation do you recognize in your own life? (130.2)

Open this up to the group.

- Asserting myself is egotistic
- Giving in or showing mercy is weak
- Giving out of shame because we fear the accusation of selfishness
- Accusing ourselves of greed and then over-giving because we think others are judging us
- Swallowing my hurt or fears because to express them is selfish and might stir up conflict

25. What stunts the capacity for constructive self-criticism and mars the possibility of learning from mistakes? (131.1)

The necessity to ward off self-accusation.

We can't accept feedback from others because it adds to our self-condemnation.

We can't allow others to express their needs and wants because it makes us feel threatened

We use humor to ward off self-hate

Our dishonesty and our choices are often an indication of the panic that we feel most of the time

26. Compare a healthy conscience with neurotic self-accusation. (131.2–132.1)

Open this question to the group. There are no right answers.

Healthy conscience

- Vigilantly guards best interest of the true self
- Constructive examination
- Faces squarely the wrong done or the faulty attitude
- A moral agency serving our growth
- Finds responsibility within ourselves

Neurotic self-accusation

- Stems from neurotic pride; attacks the true self
- Condemns the whole personality as bad
- Self-condemnation stops short of a positive move
- Amoral in origin, immoral in effect
- Shifts responsibility

- Works toward overcoming eventually
- Constructive discontent with self
- Works toward suppressing the problem
- Internalized fear of authority

27. What is meant by “self-contempt”? (132.2)

Self-contempt is an overall term for the manifold ways of undermining self-confidence: self-belittling, self-disparaging, self-doubting, self-discrediting, and self-ridicule.

28. What is self-contempt mainly directed against? (132.2)

Self-contempt is mainly directed against any striving for improvement or achievement.

We might simply refuse to work toward our potential, or we work and then sabotage ourselves. Striving for improvement would require facing up to all the things we hate about ourselves. We cannot envision a world in which the mere striving for self-improvement will help us hate ourselves less and provide more resources for dealing with any challenges that come our way. The energy that we squander in self-contempt could be directed toward making a real contribution in this messed up world, which would enhance the glory and reputation of our Lord.

We might compare this self-contempt with gambling on slot machines, which are programmed to take our money. The self-contempt of gamblers prevents them from using their money for their own improvement or for improving the world.

29. What are the four consequences of self-contempt? (133.3–137)

A. **A compulsive need to compare ourselves with everyone else, and to compare ourselves to our own disadvantage**

The most frequent comparisons are of attractiveness and intelligence. Nancy would also add the comparison of some kind of desired success. Not only are these comparisons unfair, but they are often not based on reality.

B. **Vulnerability in human relations**

Self-contempt makes the neurotic hypersensitive to criticism and rejection.

We often invite into our lives people who will abuse us or affirm our reason to hate ourselves. Neurotics blindly assume that others despise them, which points to the fact that the bulk of self-contempt is externalized.

C. **Taking too much abuse from others**

D. **The need to alleviate or balance self-contempt with the attention, regard, appreciation, admiration, or love of others**

The result is a total dependence on others for self-evaluation: it rises and falls with the attitudes of others toward us.

Almost everyone Nancy has worked with is terrified of what others will think of them.

30. Compare healthy self-discipline, or voluntary renunciation, with self-frustration. (140.4–141.3)

Self-discipline/Voluntary Renunciation

- Will forego activities or satisfactions
- Hierarchy of values, honoring limitations
- Knowing real wishes and capable of renouncing one for a more important one

Self-frustration

- Wishes are actually compulsive needs
- All wishes and needs rank equal in importance
- Limitations are overruled. No goal or wish can be renounced

- Goals are to be approximated
- Aware of the reality of the situation
- Freedom of choice
- Self-respect
- Joy
- Goals must be actual and perfected
- Only aware of the compelling shoulds
- Compulsive drives, pseudosolutions for conflicts
- Self-contempt
- Frustrating joy by inviting self-hate; taboos on enjoyment

Neurotics are frustrated beings. Our drives, conflicts, and alienation from our real self crush our joy and prevent us from realizing our potential. We feel frustrated because we claim an unlimited ability to do it all (and to do it now). As Christians, we might use a verse like “I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me” to support our need to override limitations. We hate our real assets and strengths, and only value what we imagine our potential could be.

1:00/0:45 WI

31. Do you experience these or other taboos? Which ones? (141.4–145.2)

Open this question to the group.

- I should never be the leader of a growing ministry
- Making any mistake
- Self-improvement feels selfish or a waste of time
- Doing anything just for myself feels scary and lonely
- Ordering the food I really want will make me fat and waste my money
- When I deny myself anything I feel unimportant and deprived
- Saving or wasting money will bring on some kind of disaster
- Gaining or losing weight will create more difficulties
- Moods or sexual feelings are dangerous
- Any kind of success
- Kindness and humility when others make a mistake or change their minds

32. What is in part an inevitable by-product of self-hate? (145.3)

Self-torture.

33. In which of these or other ways do you torture yourself? (145.3–148.2)

Open this question to the group.

- Anxiety
- Imagining disaster or fortune-telling disappointing outcomes
- Taking on tasks that I am not prepared for
- Procrastination
- Making choices that create outcomes that I can forever regret
- Guilt
- Replaying in my head shameful or humiliating experiences

34. Self-hate finally culminates in what? (148.3)

Pure and direct self-destructive impulses and actions.

35. What are some of the ways in which you self-destruct? (148.3–151.2)

Open this question to the group.

- Take too many risks, and then I kind of want to get caught
- Mindless communication, untrustworthiness
- Refusal to attend KF meetings or use the tools
- Choosing a career path before I'm ready to make it a success, then going into debt
- Continuing to work, even though it is evident that I need rest
- Staying up too late
- Bodily damage, poor self-care, forgetting to take medications or supplements
- Anesthetizing ourselves so that we don't feel or notice the self-destruction

36. What does the patient keep trying to make others do? (151.2)

He continues to try to make others the executioners of his self-ruining interests.

We get into relationships that cannot be anything but detrimental to us. Those who would do us the most harm are often the ones that we are most attracted to and obsessed with.

We designate others to be enemies and continually provoke them into confirming the judgments we have made about them.

37. Toward what do self-destructive people silently, but actively, collaborate? (151.3)

They collaborate toward their own moral deterioration.

We have a diminished capacity for being sincere with ourselves.

Our moral deterioration is one of the most dangerous aspects of neurosis. In Jeremiah 17:9-10 we read, "The heart is deceitful above all else and desperately sick. Who can understand it? I, the Lord, search the heart and examine the mind, and reward each person according to their conduct, according to what their deeds deserve." The Lord does us a great favor when He reveals to us the quality of our choices by allowing us to experience the consequences of our actions. The quality of our lives reveals our true moral and spiritual development.

Sincerity is destructive to a neurotic market economy and, unfortunately, it is often in the best interest of others to prevent us from being honest with ourselves. If we learn to act out of our true moral and spiritual development, we may not readily participate in the agenda of another person, an institution, or our culture.

38. What is perhaps the greatest tragedy of the human mind? (154.2)

Self-hate and its ravaging force.

We reach out for the infinite and absolute but also start destroying ourselves. We make a pact with the devil who promises glory but sends us to hell. This pact is an illusion based on our shoulds and claims.

Perhaps you are recognizing self-hate for the first time and wonder why you never saw it before. There is wisdom in not allowing our self-hate to become conscious until we have the tools to cope with it.

39. Read **Romans 7:14–8:2**. What does Paul offer as the solution to the human struggle with self-hate?

The karis gift of Christ Jesus, in whom there is no condemnation.

0:55 WI students take a five-minute break. Break-out room (subgroup) facilitator returns to the main meeting (*3*) to report attendance and homework, then goes back to the subgroup and waits for the next facilitator to arrive before signing off. Facilitator, do not turn off the recording.

1:15 All weekly subgroups return to the main group for discussion and closing by pressing *3*.

Here are some discussion questions:

- Does anyone have any comments or questions?
- What strikes you about self-hate?
- Are you more critical of yourself or of others?
- Would you call yourself a people-pleaser, a punisher, a “standards and evaluation officer”, or indifferent?
- What do you most fear from others?
- How can we learn to have sympathy for ourselves and also remain aware of how our behavior affects others?
- How might your trust in the work of Jesus on the cross help you tackle self-hate?
- If you weren’t motivated by self-hate, what might motivate you instead?
- How do you think God feels about our self-hate?

1:30 (approx.) Lead Facilitator: Dismiss the group and stop the recording. (*9 then 1)

All facilitators, please stay after the meeting to confirm student attendance and homework completion on the [NHG Attendance Spreadsheet](#).

Lead Facilitator: “Are there any comments or questions?”

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.